

COURSE INFORMATION

Course Code & Title COR-OBHR.1309 - Negotiating in Management and Business	Effective Start Date 17/08/2026
Offering Unit / Department / School LKCSB	Course Career Undergraduate
Course Units CU: 1	Grading Basis GRD - Graded

Course Description

Negotiation is the art and science of securing agreements between parties who are interdependent, are seeking to maximize their own outcomes, and may or may not be interested in developing or preserving a close relationship. This course is designed to be relevant to the broad spectrum of negotiation problems faced by managers and professionals. A basic premise of this course is that while any manager or professional needs analytical skills to discover optimal solutions to problems, negotiation skills are usually needed to get these solutions accepted and implemented. This course provides participants with conceptual and analytical tools for analyzing and planning their negotiations. It also provides participants with simulated negotiation experiences that allow them to develop their negotiating skills, and to understand how the conceptual and analytical tools can be used in practice.

Course Learning Outcomes

By the end of this course, students will achieve the following learning outcomes:

- I. Disciplinary and Multidisciplinary Knowledge, & Intellectual and Creative Skills:
- Understand and be able to put into practice the central frameworks, principles, concepts and theories in negotiation.
- II. Interpersonal Skills & Personal Mastery:
- Gain negotiation experience, skills, and confidence.
- Obtain the insights needed to learn on an ongoing basis from their own future negotiations.

SMU Graduate Learning Outcomes

Multidisciplinary knowledge, Interdisciplinary knowledge, Critical thinking & problem solving, Collaboration and leadership, Communication, Ethics and social responsibility

Competencies

Business Acumen, Business Negotiation, Conflict Management, Employee and Labour Relations, Management Decision Making

Course Area(s)

AREA - Business Options, AREA - Business-Oriented Electives, AREA - Capabilities - Managing, AREA - Econ Major Rel/Econ Options, AREA - General Education, AREA - Org Behaviour & HR Electives, AREA - Social Sciences/PLE Major-related, AREA - University Core, ENRL - SS Enrolment: 6 ISEP; 1 SUSEP, RQCX - LAW403, RQCX - LAW482, RQCX - LGST220, RQCX - LGST221, RQCX - OBHR218, TRCK - Culture, Org & Behaviour Track (Business)

Simple Requisites

COR-OBHR1309/OBHR218/LGST220/LGST2221/LGST222/LAW403/LAW482 - Mutually Exclusive

Type
Antirequisite

Enroll in the following Courses:

- OBHR.218 - Negotiation Skills for Business
- LGST220 - Negotiation (Inactive)
- LGST221 - Conflict Resolution (Inactive)
- LGST222 - Negotiation and Conflict Resolution (Inactive)
- LAW403 - Negotiation and Mediation for Lawyers
- LAW482 - Deal-making and Dispute Resolution: Negotiation in an Age of Disruption

CLASS SECTION INFORMATION

Instructor(s)
MICHAEL SCHAEERER - (schaerer@smu.edu.sg)

Instruction Mode In Person	Consultations and Teaching Assistants If you need to see me for consultation, please contact me to make an appointment. My office and contact information are listed at the top of this course outline. I am also readily available by email.	Office Location LKCSB #5079
--------------------------------------	---	---------------------------------------

Assessment Components (New)

Category* Class Participation	Weightage* 25		
Individual or Group?* Individual	With Writing Component?* No	With Oral Component?* Yes	

Category* Projects/Assignments	Weightage* 20	Assessment/Submission Period* Week 13	
Description Real-World Negotiation Assignment	Individual or Group?* Individual	With Writing Component?* Yes	With Oral Component?* No

Category* Projects/Assignments	Weightage* 20	Assessment/Submission Period* Week 13	
Description Final Group Presentation	Individual or Group?* Group	With Writing Component?* No	With Oral Component?* Yes

Category* Final Examination	Weightage* 35	Assessment/Submission Period* Week 15	
Description Final Exam	Individual or Group?* Individual	With Writing Component?* Yes	With Oral Component?* No

Instructional Methods and Expectations

1. Class Participation (25%):

This is intended to facilitate your own and your class mates’ learning experience. Points will be given for the quality and quantity of your contributions to in-class discussions. Class participation also includes attendance of lectures, full preparation prior to class including preparing assigned materials and participating in surveys, timely completion of assignments, and participation in course related activities such as class discussions and team activities. To do well on class participation, aim to attend all the lectures, prepare well for class, complete your homework assignments thoroughly and timely, be on time, and contribute to the in-class experience. If you are unable to attend class, please notify me at least 48 hours in advance (whenever possible) as negotiation partners for class exercises are typically pre assigned and provide documentation (e.g., medical certificate) where applicable.

2. Real-World Negotiation Assignment (20%):

The purpose of the real-world assignment is to apply your knowledge and gain real-world experience in negotiations. One reason why people often fail to negotiate is because they are inexperienced, shy, or don’t think something is negotiable. The best way to overcome these anxieties is to go out and negotiate! For this assignment, you should aim to engage in two real-world negotiations. You can negotiate anything you like. Be creative. Your negotiations could involve a good or service from a merchant, a salary or bonus with an employer, a discount from a service provider, a product on Carousell / Craigslist, or anything else. Also, note that you do not have to buy anything to complete this assignment. Similarly, your negotiations do not need to be a success – often, we learn as much from negotiations that fail as from those that succeed.

After you have completed the negotiations, write a short report (a maximum of 3 pages, single-spaced, 12-point font, excluding cover page, references, and appendices) in which you describe and analyze your experiences. The short report should be submitted online via e-Learn by the deadline communicated in class.

The report should describe the key learning points from your negotiations. The report should not purely be a detailed description of everything that happened – instead you should try to analyze the factors influencing the negotiation process. Provide only brief details of the negotiations themselves and give examples as illustrations of your points. The report should address issues such as:

- a) Which critical factors affected the negotiation outcomes?
- b) What have you learned about yourself as a negotiator from these experiences (e.g., what are your strengths and weaknesses)?
- c) What have you learned about the behaviors of others in negotiations?
- d) What were some of your successes and failures and how will you approach similar negotiations situations in the future?
- e) What are the similarities and differences between your negotiation outside of class compared to those negotiations you did inside of class?
- f) Explicitly link these insights to concepts and principles from class and the readings.

A high-quality analysis steps back from the negotiations and looks at the ‘bigger picture’, indicates how the negotiation exercises will help you become a better negotiator in the future, uses course concepts to help structure the analysis, and is well written. Do not just list the events as they happened; instead, write more like a ‘critical commentator’ who provides an in-depth analysis of why things happened, what you learned about yourself and other negotiators, how this knowledge will impact your future negotiations, and how these experiences relate to what you learned in class.

3. Final Group Presentation (20%):

For this assignment, you will collaborate in groups to analyze a past or ongoing real-world negotiation. The negotiation to be analyzed should be of historic, economic, and/or political significance (e.g., Cuban missile crisis, Malaysia-Singapore High Speed Rail, etc.). The negotiation does not have to be a success; we can learn a lot from failed negotiations as well. To identify and analyze a negotiation, you may consult publicly available information (e.g., news articles, history books, interviews). The final group presentation should include the following components:

- a) Synthesis: Provide a very brief overview of the negotiation and the key actors involved. This should be kept short and only provide as much information as necessary for the presentation audience to understand the situation.
- b) In-depth analysis of the negotiation: The analysis involves using the theories and concepts from class to identify and understand the negotiation parties, dynamics, strategies, and/or situation. Good analyses take a step back and look at the situation from a holistic perspective (e.g., put yourself into the shoes of the different actors involved) and use concepts from class and/or the readings to put the situation in perspective. You are welcome to rely on additional literature/research or concepts from other classes where helpful.
- c) Critical assessment and recommendations: Based on your analysis, identify what went well and what did not. Then, provide practical, but science-based, recommendations for the negotiators involved (i.e., what should they do [if ongoing], or what could they have done better or differently [if in the past]?). Depending on the nature of the negotiation you identified, your recommendations may be targeted at a specific individual (e.g., politician, CEO), a group of individuals (e.g., board of directors of a company), or an entity (e.g., a government or organization). Good presentations not only identify specific, actionable, and evidence-based recommendations, but also reflect on the potential negative consequences or situations under which the recommended actions may not be effective.

The final group presentation should be about 12-15 minutes long followed by 3 minutes for questions (if any). The duration of the final presentation may be adjusted on a year-by-year basis depending on the number of students enrolled and the resulting number of groups.

You will have the chance to inform me if any team member did not do his/her fair and/or agreed upon share of the work. Provided there is consistency among team members about this, I will feel free to reduce the particular team member’s class participation grade. Note that problems with team members should ideally be solved within the team as resolving differences and conflicts is a crucial negotiation and leadership skill. However, if you feel that your situation cannot be resolved within your team, you may contact the instructor to set up a team meeting.

4. Final Exam (35%):

The exam will be a 2-hour closed-book exam and consist of multiple choice (50%) and short answer questions (50%) that test your mastery of major concepts and theories that we discuss in class. The exam will be based both on lecture content and the assigned readings. To get high scores from the exam, you need to study the assigned readings (chapters in textbook and supplementary articles) thoroughly and attend the lectures to form a better understanding of the key concepts, theories, and their applications.

CLASS ETIQUETTE, ELECTRONIC DEVICES, AND ATTENDANCE

Please respect other members of this class by not disrupting class. If you arrive late, leave early, or take a break during class, please do your best to minimize disruptions while arriving/leaving. Mobile phones should be turned off during class. Laptop computers or tablets are only permitted to take notes and for class activities. The use of instant messaging (Facebook, WhatsApp, etc.), online games, or other programs and websites not related to note-taking or class activities are distracting your neighbors and explicitly not permitted. Violations of this norm will lead to significant reductions in your Class Participation grade.

Students with unexcused absences from class for 4 or more sessions may be given an “F” for that class. Late class attendance and non-completion of blended learning materials may be counted as an absence from class.

Weekly Lesson Plan

WEEK	TOPIC	BEFORE CLASS	CLASS ACTIVITIES	AFTER CLASS
1	Introduction to Negotiations	Preparation ▪ Read syllabus ▪ Complete survey before first class (will be emailed)	Class Activity ▪ Cars #1-3	Readings ▪ Chapters 1-2 ▪ “The Four Horsemen of Power at the Bargaining Table”
2	Distributive Negotiations	Preparation ▪ none	Class Activity ▪ Biopharm Seltek	Readings ▪ Chapter 3 Tasks ▪ Provide feedback ▪ Negotiation strategy
3	Integrative Negotiations	Preparation ▪ none	Class Activity ▪ Holy Crab	Readings ▪ “Investigative Negotiation” Tasks ▪ Provide feedback ▪ Negotiation strategy
4	Complex Negotiations	Preparation ▪ none	Class Activity ▪ New Hire	Readings ▪ Chapter 4 Tasks ▪ Provide feedback ▪ Negotiation strategy
5	Negotiating in Teams	Preparation ▪ Read role for Cartoon	Class Activity ▪ Cartoon	Readings ▪ Chapter 9 (pp. 230-234) ▪ “How to Manage Your Negotiating Team” ▪ “Betting on the future: The virtues of contingent contracts”
6	Agents and Ethics in Negotiations	Preparation ▪ none	Class Activity ▪ Bullard Houses	Readings ▪ Chapter 7 (pp. 175-182) ▪ Chapter 9 (pp. 222-227) Tasks ▪ Provide feedback
7	Dispute Resolution	Preparation ▪ none	Class Activity ▪ Viking	Readings ▪ “Three Approaches to Resolving Disputes” Tasks ▪ Provide feedback
8				
9	Negotiating in the “Wild”	Preparation ▪ none	Class Activity ▪ Engage in two real-world negotiations	Tasks ▪ Complete real-world negotiation assignment
10	Special Topic (eLearn): Artificial Intelligence and Negotiation	Preparation ▪ see Assignment (email)	Class Activity ▪ see Assignment (email)	Readings ▪ see Assignment (email)
11	Negotiating in a Global Context	Preparation ▪ Read role for Mouse	Class Activity ▪ Mouse	Readings ▪ Chapter 10 ▪ “Getting to Si, Ja, Oui, Hai, and Da”
12	Group Consultations	Preparation ▪ none	Class Activity ▪ Group consultations	
13	Final Group Presentations	Preparation ▪ Submit group project & real-world negotiation assignment	Class Activity ▪ Presentations	
14	Study Week			
15	Exam Week			

To demonstrate that you have carefully read the syllabus from the beginning to the end, please send a picture of any dinosaur of your choice to the following email address before our first class: COROBHR1309@gmail.com

Recommended Textbooks and Readings

The main textbook used in this class is Leigh Thompson’s “The Mind and Heart of the Negotiator”. There is no need for you to purchase a copy of the book as the required chapters will be provided to you via e-Learn each week and may span multiple different editions of the book. Of course, you are free to use your own version of this textbook, but it is your responsibility to make sure that the content in your physical copy is identical to the chapters provided on e-Learn. While the Thompson textbook is helpful in providing an overview of most negotiation topics and provides a thread throughout the class, certain topics may not be covered in-depth or new research has emerged since the respective chapters have been published. Thus, for some lectures there may be additional readings to help you deepen your expertise in these topics. The additional readings are listed in the Course Schedule below. Supplementary readings will typically be posted on e-Learn at least one week in advance.

UNIVERSITY POLICIES

Academic Integrity

All acts of academic dishonesty (including, but not limited to, plagiarism, cheating, fabrication, facilitation of acts of academic dishonesty by others, unauthorized possession of exam questions, or tampering with the academic work of other students) are serious offences.

All work (whether oral or written) submitted for purposes of assessment must be the student’s own work. Penalties for violation of the policy range from zero marks for the component assessment to expulsion, depending on the nature of the offence.

When in doubt, students should consult the instructors of the course. Details on the SMU Code of Academic Integrity may be accessed at <https://smu.sharepoint.com/sites/oasis/SitePages/DOS-WKLSWC/UCSC.aspx>.

Responsible Use of AI

The University recognises the importance of equipping students with the skills to navigate an AI-driven world. While AI tools may support learning, they must be used judiciously and responsibly. Students must not present AI-generated output as their own work.

Each course may set specific guidelines on the use of AI in assessments. Students are required to follow these guidelines carefully and should seek clarification from the instructors if uncertain.

Misuse of AI constitutes a breach of academic integrity and will be subject to the same penalties as other acts of academic dishonesty.

Copyright Notice

Please note that all course materials are meant for personal use only, namely for the purposes of teaching, studying and research. You are strictly not permitted to make copies of or print additional copies or distribute such copies of the course materials or any parts thereof, for commercial gain or exchange.

For the full copyright notice, please visit <https://researchguides.smu.edu.sg/copyright>.

Accessibility

SMU strives to make learning experiences accessible for all. Students who anticipate or experience physical or academic barriers due to disability are encouraged to inform the course instructor as soon as possible. Students may also contact the university's disability services team if they have questions or concerns about academic provisions: accessibility@smu.edu.sg. Please be aware that the accessible tables in our seminar room should remain available for students who require them.

Digital Readiness for Teaching and Learning (DRTL)

As part of emergency preparedness, instructors may conduct lessons online via the Zoom platform during the term, to prepare students for online learning. During an actual emergency, students will be notified to access the Zoom platform for their online lessons. The class schedule will mirror the current face-to-face class timetable unless otherwise stated.